

Nadja Herger, PhD

Data & Analytics • AI Governance • Senior Data Scientist • Digital Change and Transformation

About

Nationality:	Switzerland	E-Mail:	hergernadja@gmail.com
Languages:	German (native), English (fluent), French (familiarity)	Website:	https://nherger.github.io
		LinkedIn:	https://www.linkedin.com/in/nadja-herger

Profile

Purpose-driven professional with demonstrated expertise in Data Science and Responsible AI. Robust technical background with 8+ years of experience in analysing complex datasets through advanced AI/ML methods to gain novel insights into data and deliver solutions with real-world impact. Proficient in communication, stakeholder management, and change management, particularly in the context of spearheading the implementation of an enterprise-wide AI Governance program. Substantial experience in effectively leading high-performing globally-distributed teams in a large organisation.

Work Experience

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| Jun 2024 - present | Adoption Manager Data & Analytics • Axpo, Trading & Sales • Baden, Switzerland <ul style="list-style-type: none">- Co-authored the business area's first Data Strategy, defining the vision as well as key building blocks to become a data-driven company. Led the communication strategy.- Leading a thriving Data & Analytics Community, consisting of 300+ members from over 15 countries, focussed on knowledge sharing, networking, and training. Organising monthly virtual events, as well as annual in-person conferences with 150 participants on strategically important themes.- Responsible for the adoption of a novel state-of-the-art Data & Analytics Platform for business users, data engineers, analysts. Regularly reporting on key KPIs.- Leading the business areas Data Literacy program with dedicated e-learning. |
| Apr 2023 - May 2024 | Director, Model Stewardship • Thomson Reuters, Data & Analytics • Zug, Switzerland <ul style="list-style-type: none">- Managing a high-performing team of 7 individuals across 4 countries.- Contributing to internal comms initiatives around AI, AI Governance, and Ethics.- Develop guidance and enterprise training around the responsible use of GenAI.- Translate internal Standards into effective controls and scalable, innovative implementation practices, suitable for different levels of maturity across TR.- Increasing the awareness and adoption of model performance monitoring. |
| Jul 2022 - Apr 2023 | Manager, Model Stewardship • Thomson Reuters, Data & Analytics • Zug, Switzerland <ul style="list-style-type: none">- Managing a high-performing team of 4 Model Steward Partners across 3 countries.- Responsible for introducing AI Governance to all model-developing and owning teams across TR, including the creation of training material (workshops, learning modules), org-wide communication, providing support to ensure compliance to newly introduced Policies and Standards. Oversight of 300+ AI-powered solutions across the company. Measure and visualise the rate of adoption via dashboards.- Stakeholder and change management to create a culture of accountability around the design, development, and deployment of trustworthy AI solutions.- Member of TR's internal Ethics Advisory Committee. |
| Jan - Jun 2022 | Manager, Data and Model Ethics • Thomson Reuters, Data & Analytics • Zug, Switzerland <ul style="list-style-type: none">- Managing a team of 2 Senior Policy Analysts across 2 locations (CH, CA).- Support the build-out of the Data and AI Ethics strategy and framework.- Provide technical advice and training on data and AI ethics-related issues (incl. tooling, best practices) to various stakeholders across the enterprise.- Supported the initiative to embed ethics-as-a-service as part of the AI Platform. |
| Apr - Dec 2021 | Senior Data Scientist • Thomson Reuters, TR Labs • Zug, Switzerland <ul style="list-style-type: none">- Lead of the Human-Centric AI research theme as part of the Labs research program. Oversight of various research projects, and definition of the research direction.- Involvement in a research project around interactive topic modeling, as well as exploration of data drift for unstructured text. |

- Took on the Data Science lead role for a range of Natural Language Processing (NLP) projects, responsible for coordinating work amongst a group of Data Scientists, and communicating results with stakeholders.
- Played a crucial role in recruiting a team of Data Scientists in London and Bangalore.

Sep 2018 -
Mar 2021

Data Scientist • Thomson Reuters, TR Labs • Zug, Switzerland

- Contributed to various NLP projects, including classification, summarization, entity extraction, using traditional Machine Learning techniques as well as Deep Learning. Analysed data and trained models using AWS Sagemaker.
- Mentored several Data Science interns.
- Participated in a working group to develop Thomson Reuters' first AI Principles.

Jul 2015 -
Jul 2018

PhD in Climate Science • University of New South Wales • Sydney, Australia

- Combined global climate model output in a way that their interdependency is accounted for. The optimal subset is used to better constrain future climate projections (mainly temperature and precipitation fields).
- Used Machine Learning tools such as multidimensional scaling and clustering to better understand the relationship between climate models and observations.
- Published several peer-reviewed articles and presented at various conferences.

Skills

Data Science: From traditional Machine Learning to advanced Generative AI; AI Ethics; Automation
 Coding: Python (advanced), MATLAB (intermediate), R (beginner), bash, SQL; GitHub
 Cloud: Azure Databricks, AWS (Sagemaker - Clarify & Monitor, S3, EC2, Bedrock)
 Leadership: Team Leadership, Stakeholder Management, Change Management, Communication, Creative Problem-Solving, Breaking Down Silos, Accessible Knowledge Sharing
 Courses: Leading Organisations in Disruptive Times (INSEAD, 2025), Ethical AI (Udacity, 2024), Generative AI with LLMs (Coursera, 2023), Data Ethics & Responsible AI (EDM, 2023), All Tech is Human Mentorship Program (2024)

Education

2015 -	Ph.D. in Climate Science (Climate Change Research Centre)	UNSW Sydney
2018	Thesis: <i>Towards a viable alternative to model democracy using optimal climate model subset selection</i> • Won the Dean's Award for Outstanding PhD Theses.	(Australia)
2013 -	M.Sc. in Environmental Sciences (Major in Atmosphere and Climate)	ETH Zurich
2015	Thesis: <i>Predicting climate change by fixed patterns: Improved approaches and limitations</i> • Conducted at NCAR in Boulder, USA • Grade: 5.79 out of 6 (degree awarded "with distinction")	(Switzerland)
2010 -	B.Sc. in Environmental Sciences (Focus on Atmosphere and Climate)	ETH Zurich
2013	Thesis: <i>Susceptibilities in mixed-phase aerosol-cloud interaction simulated over an Alpine transect</i> • Grade: 5.46 out of 6	(Switzerland)

Awards

2019	Dean's Award for Outstanding PhD Theses This award recognises PhD graduates who have produced a thesis that is considered outstanding by both examiners.	UNSW Sydney (Australia)
2015 - 2018	University International Postgraduate Award Covers the full cost of tuition fees during the Ph.D. programme (AUD \$117,360) and provides a living allowance valued at AUD \$77,547 in total.	UNSW Sydney (Australia)
2015 - 2018	Top up scholarship AUD \$15,000 in total from the Climate Change Research Centre.	UNSW Sydney (Australia)
2013 - 2015	Excellence Scholarship and Opportunity Programme Covers the full study and living costs (CHF 44,000) and tuition fee waiver (CHF 2,596) during the MSc degree. Awarded to the top 2% of students starting a MSc programme.	ETH Zurich (Switzerland)

Publications and Public Speaking

I have led and co-authored a range of peer-reviewed articles which are published in scientific journals. The full list can be found here: <https://nherger.github.io/publications/>

I had the pleasure to present at various academic and industry conferences, events and meetups. Topics include AI Ethics (incl. Explainable AI) and use cases of Natural Language Processing in industry. A select list of speaking engagements can be found here: <https://nherger.github.io/speaking/>